

ParentVeda Community

One social layer, three stages: Trying to Conceive, Pregnancy, Parenting

Feature documentation · generated from the app source

What this document is

A description of the Community feature as it exists in the ParentVeda app today, across all three stages. It is written from the code and the seeded data, not from a plan, so where something is a prototype or a stub it says so.

Nothing in the app was changed to produce this.

Reading it in one line: Community is a single social layer that a family joins once and keeps for years. The rooms change as they move from trying, to pregnant, to parenting. What they joined, saved and wrote does not.

The one idea worth understanding first

Most apps in this space would build three community features — one per stage — because the three audiences look different. ParentVeda builds one, and swaps the content.

There is a single `CommunityStore`. It holds joins, likes, saves, bookmarks, poll votes, comments and the user's own posts, keyed by id. Three separate content sets sit on top of it: TTC rooms, pregnancy rooms, parenting rooms.

The consequence is the point:

- A room joined while trying to conceive is still joined after a positive test.
- A post saved during pregnancy is still saved two years later in the parenting feed.
- A woman who wrote something at week 9 still owns it when her child is three.

This is the difference between a product a family passes through and one they stay in. It is also why the TTC community took days rather than weeks to build: the social layer already existed, and only the rooms and the tone were new.

The rule it follows: if a capability already exists for another stage, extend it rather than building a parallel one. Two of a thing is what makes one app feel like two apps.

What a member can actually do

Every stage shares this. It is a real social product, not a comment box.

Rooms

Communities are rooms with a name, a description, a topic list and a member count. Some are **auto-joined** for the stage the family is in — a due-month cohort, a trimester, a city, an age band. The rest are chosen.

Auto-joining matters more than it sounds. The most useful person to a woman at week 22 is another woman at week 22, and she will not go looking for that room. She is put in it.

Posts

Seven kinds, and they behave differently:

Type	What it is
Question	Asked of the room. The most common kind.
Experience	A story rather than a question.
Poll	Options, votes, results
Photo	Image posts, single or multiple
Milestone	A moment worth marking
Expert	Written by a verified professional
ParentVeda	Written by us, and labelled as ours

Actions

Like, comment, save, upvote, repost, share, hide, and mute a whole room. Every one persists locally and syncs to the account, so it survives a reinstall and a new phone.

Composer

Choose the room, choose the post type, attach photos, record audio, or tick **request verification** — which asks a professional to weigh in and routes it by specialty.

Profiles

Tapping any author — expert or member — opens a profile with a follow button, post and follower counts, and a Posts / Videos toggle. Experts additionally carry a credential chip and a bio.

The feed is ranked, not chronological

Except in one place, deliberately. In pregnancy and parenting the feed is scored:

```
score = likes + (comments x 2) + (saves x 3)
        + 5000   if you are in that room
        + 1000000 if you wrote it
```

Three things follow from those numbers:

- **A saved post is worth three likes.** Saving is the honest signal — it means *I will need this again*, which is closer to usefulness than a like.
- **Your own posts pin to the top.** A woman who asks something at 2am should see it where she left it.
- **Rooms you joined beat rooms you did not**, but do not exclude them, so discovery still works.

The score deliberately ignores *your* like and save toggles. An earlier version counted them, and bookmarking a post bumped its score and re-ranked the feed under your finger. The row now stays where it is when you tap save.

Trying to Conceive

New. Built last, on the existing layer.

12 rooms. Two auto-joined.

Room	Members	Auto
Trying Naturally	18,600	yes
Ask the Doctor	15,200	
PCOS	13,400	
IVF	11,700	
Emotional Support	9,300	
Nutrition	8,100	
Loss & Recovery	7,400	
Endometriosis	6,900	
First Month	5,200	yes
IUI	5,100	
Male Fertility	4,800	
Partner Lounge	3,600	

6 seeded experts — fertility, andrology, PCOS, IVF, fertility counselling, nutrition. Verification routes by: fertility, gynae, andrology, nutrition, mental health.

What is different here, and why

The feed is chronological, not ranked. This is the one stage where the scoring is switched off. Ranking by popularity turns a room where someone is on month fourteen into a leaderboard. Rooms are ordered by what the couple joined; posts appear in the order they were written.

There is a Loss & Recovery room. A product about trying to conceive that only holds hope is not honest about the stage. Like counts stay on those posts — hiding them would be its own kind of statement.

There is a Partner Lounge. Trying to conceive is the one stage where the partner is often more isolated than the woman, because nothing is visibly happening to him and nobody asks.

Male Fertility is a room, not a subtopic. Roughly half of infertility involves male factors and almost no consumer product says so at the level of navigation.

The governing line for this stage, from its own specification: *community remains calm, never competitive, never comparison-driven.*

Pregnancy

12 rooms. Three auto-joined — a due-month cohort, the current trimester, and a city.

Room	Members	Auto
First Time Moms	12,400	
Pregnancy Nutrition	9,300	
Second Trimester	8,640	yes
Working Moms	7,100	
Breastfeeding Prep	6,800	
Brain Development	5,400	
Delhi Moms	5,120	yes
Pregnancy Fitness	4,200	
High Risk Pregnancy	2,600	
IVF Pregnancy	2,100	
Twin Pregnancy	1,900	
November 2026 Moms	1,284	yes

24 seeded experts — the widest bench of the three, covering obstetrics, fetal medicine, neonatology, lactation, prenatal nutrition, pelvic health and perinatal mental health.

The due-month cohort

The auto-joined room is generated, not authored. A due date produces a room id, so **November 2026 Moms** exists because someone is due then, and every mother due that month lands in the same room.

That room is also the target of the Birth Club growth mechanic: inviting other mothers due the same month unlocks a private discussion at three invites and an expert Q&A at five. The unlocks are deliberately things that are worth having and cost nothing to give — never discounts. Paying people to recruit their friends produces recruiters, not communities.

Community Pulse

A lightweight "you are not alone" strip above the feed, with five card kinds: cohort, poll, trending, benchmark, and expert. It answers the question a woman is actually asking at 2am — **is this normal, or is it just me** — without her having to ask it.

Parenting

14 rooms. Three auto-joined — the child's age band, and two chosen by profile.

Room	Members	Auto
0–1 Year	14,200	yes
Toddler Life	13,400	
Baby Sleep	12,800	
1 Year Olds	11,200	
2 Year Olds	10,600	
Boy Moms	9,800	yes
Girl Moms	9,200	
Milestones & Development	9,100	
Starting Solids	8,900	
Working Parents	7,600	
3 Year Olds	7,300	
Delhi Parents	6,400	yes
Mumbai Parents	5,300	
Potty Training	4,300	

12 seeded experts. Verification routes by: pediatric, lactation, nutrition, sleep, development, mental health.

The parenting rooms are organised by **age band and by problem** — sleep, solids, potty training — because that is how a parent actually arrives. Nobody opens an app looking for "parenting". They open it at 11pm because the child will not sleep.

Expert verification

The mechanic is the same in all three stages, and it is the feature most likely to separate this from a forum.

A member can tick **request verification** when posting. The post is then routed by specialty and appears in a triage view for professionals. A verified professional endorses by answering — the endorsement is attached to a reply, not to a button, so it always carries a reason.

Posts show who endorsed them and how many professionals did.

Today this runs in a test mode. There is a doctor toggle in the app (Dr . (You)) so the whole flow can be walked end to end, and endorsements made that way count as one expert. Real professional logins are not connected yet — see *Known limits*.

Where the community appears in the app

It is not only a tab. The community is reachable from the places where a question naturally forms:

- The Tools tab, in pregnancy
- Explore, in parenting
- The TTC section, via its own room list
- **What Changed?** — after a parent reads about a behaviour change
- **Wonder Week** — beside the leap explanation
- The Birth Club screen, in the referral flow

The pattern is deliberate: the app answers a question first, then offers the room where other people are asking it.

Sponsorship, and its boundary

One brand product touches the community: a **sponsored community campaign** in the parenting feed, built on the "presented by" archetype.

It replaced a hardcoded brand card that sat in the feed with no campaign, no targeting, no schedule and no disclosure standard. The card looks the same. What changed is that a brand can no longer get into the feed by someone typing its name into a build method.

Two lines hold:

- **The brand funds the campaign and is named for it. It does not run it.**
- **The brand does not see who took part.**

Known limits

Stated plainly, because a document that only lists features is not useful for planning.

The whole feature is a front-end prototype over seeded data. The rooms, posts, member counts and experts are authored content, not live traffic. What is real is the structure and every action a member takes: joins, likes, saves, votes, comments and their own posts persist and sync to their account.

Specifically not built:

Area	Status
Backend feed	Ranking runs on-device over seeded posts. No server feed.
Moderation	No queue, no reporting workflow, no moderator tools.
Real expert accounts	Verification runs through a test doctor toggle.
Live expert sessions	The Birth Club Q&A unlock is a flag, not a scheduled event.
Direct messages	Not built.
Notifications	No community notifications.
Media	Photos are local; audio recording is captured but not hosted.

Of these, **moderation is the one that blocks a public launch.** A social product for pregnant women and new parents without a reporting path is not something to open to real traffic, and it is the first thing to build when this stops being a prototype.

Summary

	TTC	Pregnancy	Parenting
Rooms	12	12	14
Auto-joined	2	3	3
Seeded members	109,300	66,844	130,100
Seeded posts	10	18	22
Seeded experts	6	24	12
Feed order	chronological	ranked	ranked
Distinctive	Loss & Recovery, Partner Lounge, Male Fertility	due-month cohort, Birth Club, Pulse	age bands and problems

38 rooms, one social layer, one continuous membership from before a pregnancy to a three-year-old.